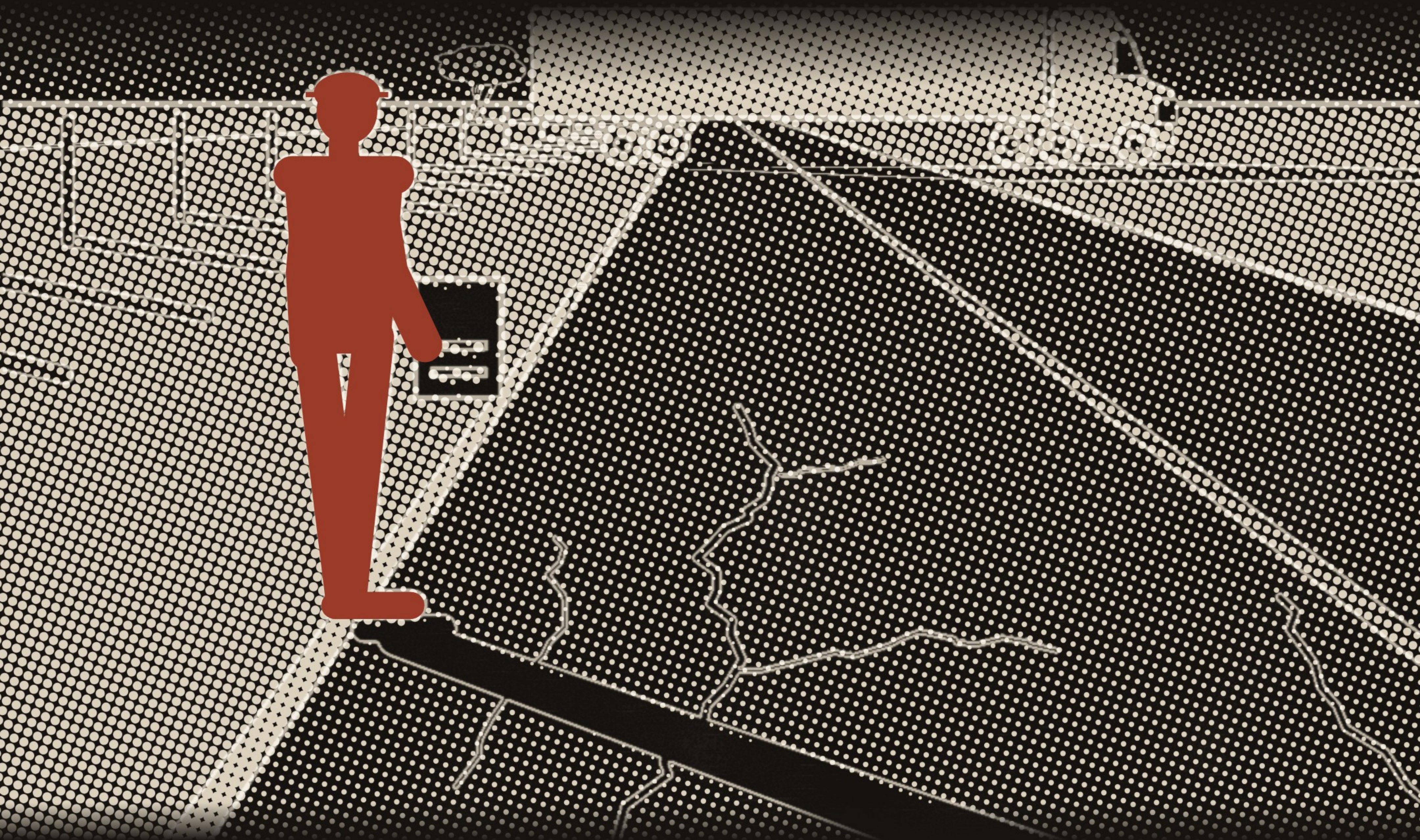
Somebody used to stand here.

A rater measured the length and severity of the distress by hand on a sampled portion of the pavement section, in the traffic and the weather.



PAVEMENT CONDITION SCORE

Seventy is where good begins.

The agency defines it as "a combined index of ride quality and pavement surface distress", adjusted for traffic and speed.

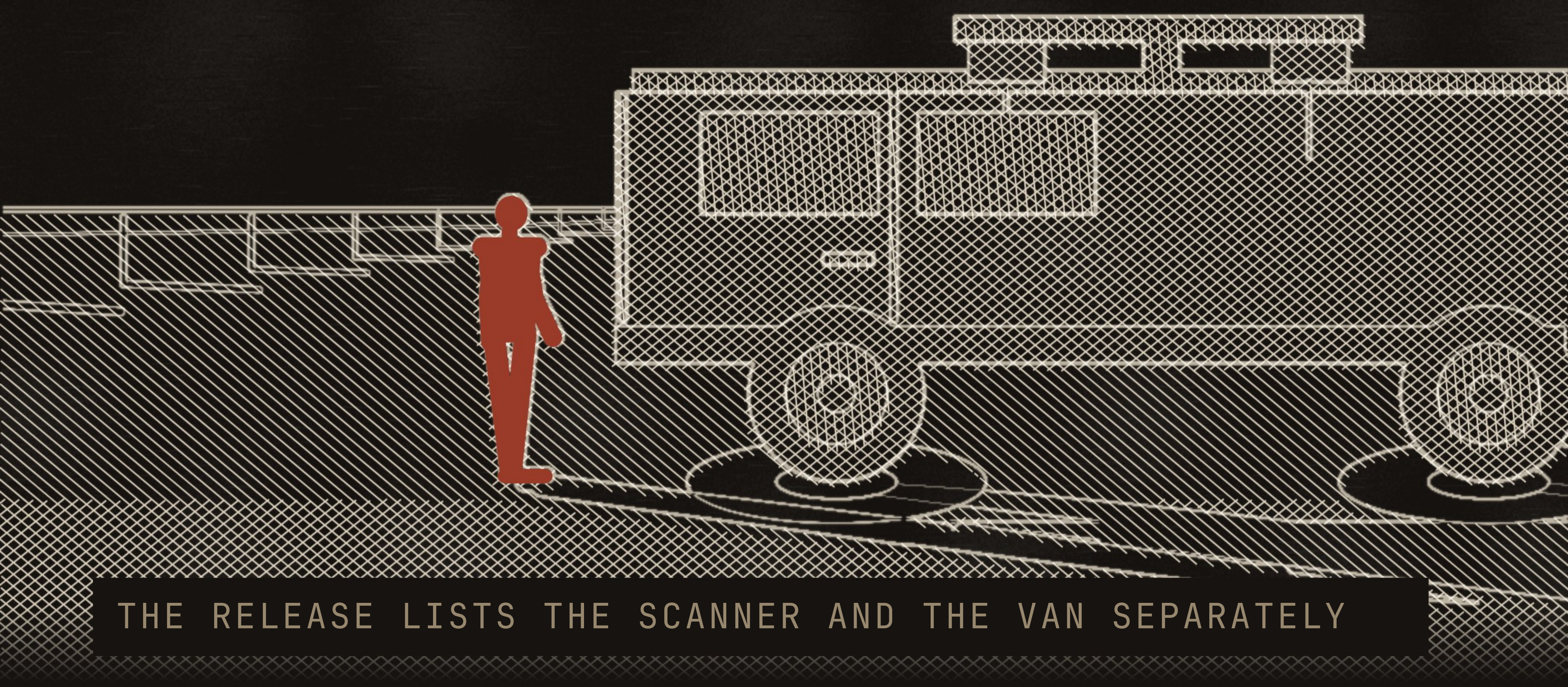
70

OR ABOVE IS GOOD OR BETTER

"Tracking pavement quality helps TxDOT identify roads in need of repair and plan funding for their maintenance and rehabilitation."

TxDOT handed over a van.

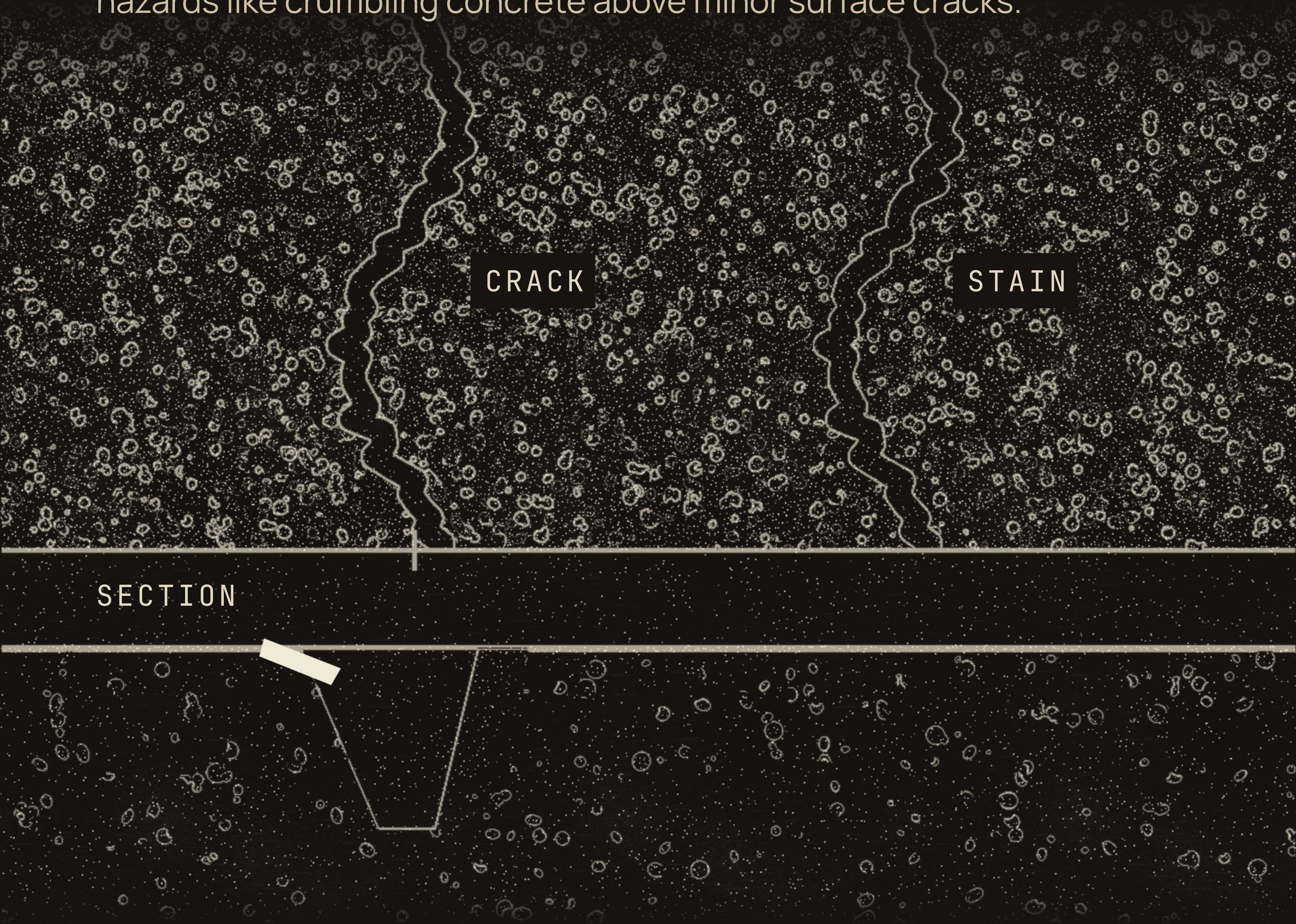
The university’s release lists what prepared the data. An automated 2D/3D pavement laser scanner, and "a TxDOT-donated mobile research van".



THE RELEASE LISTS THE SCANNER AND THE VAN SEPARATELY

Depth tells a crack from a stain.

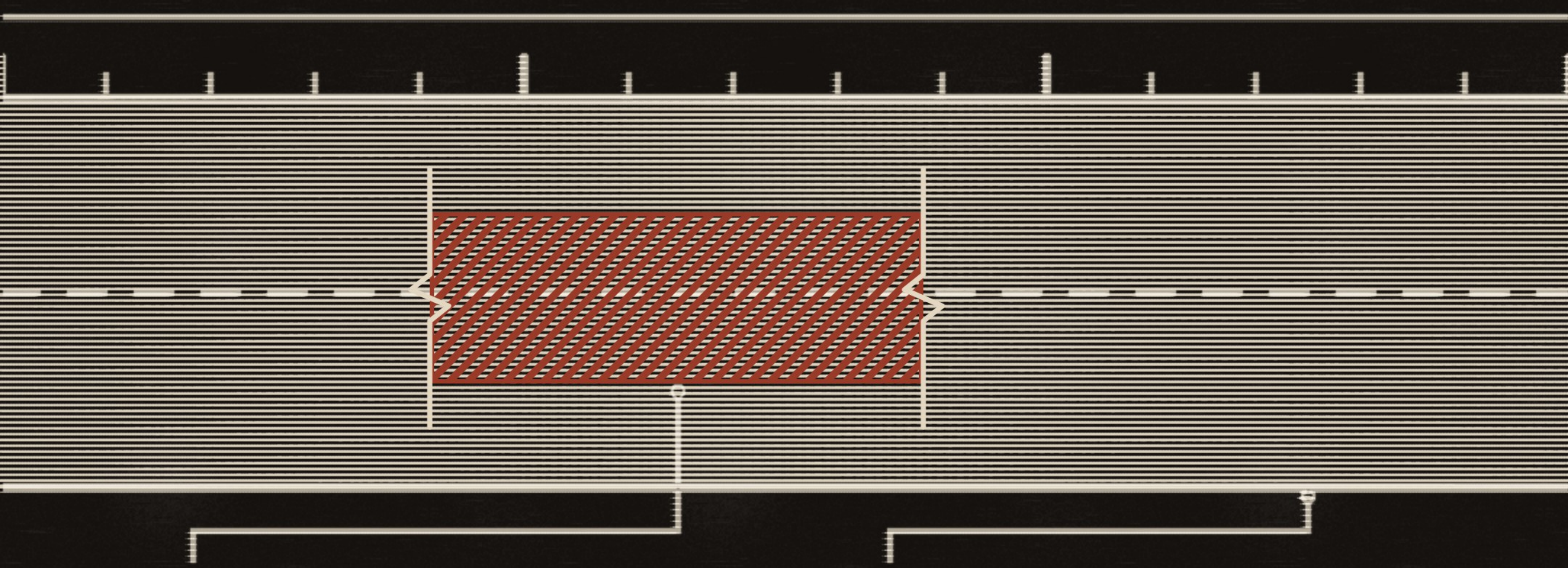
The system pairs 2D photos with 3D depth maps. It ranks severe hazards like crumbling concrete above minor surface cracks.



THE EXTENT
IN PLAN, ONE LANE

The old rating read a sample.

Manual collection happened at "a sampled portion of the pavement section". The university describes the new reading as "pixel-level detection of pavement damage".



SAMPLED PORTION
NOT STATED IN THE RELEASE

PIXEL LEVEL
THE RESOLUTION, NOT THE EXTENT

Wang describes the purpose as reducing reliance on traditional human inspection. The four words below are his.

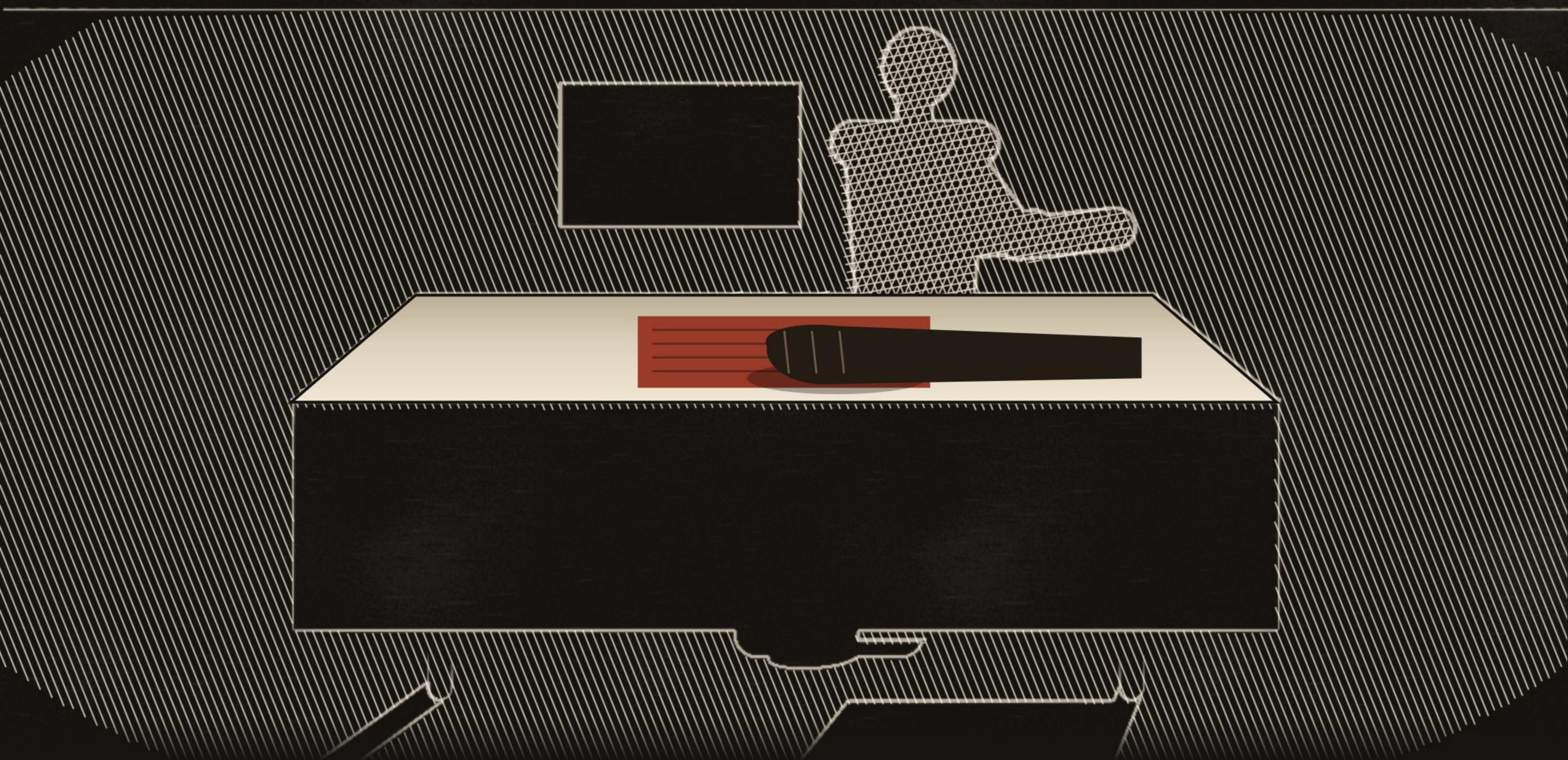
OFTEN SUBJECTIVE AND COSTLY

FENG WANG, TEXAS STATE UNIVERSITY

An engineer still has to check.

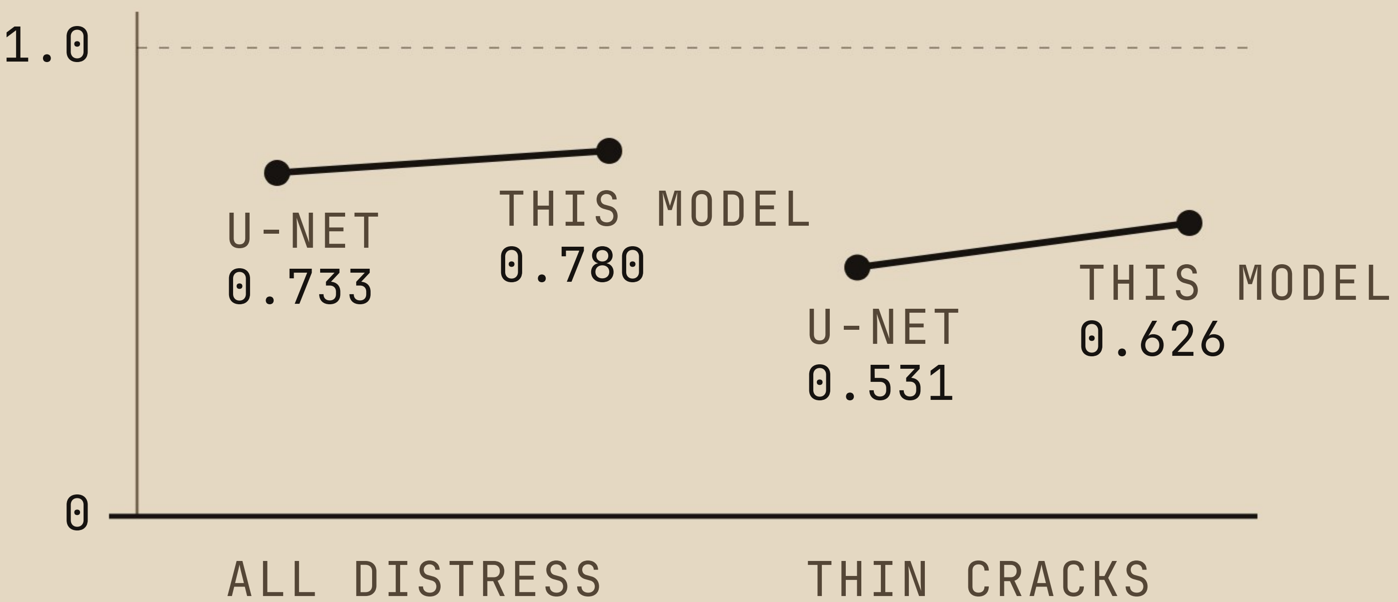
The team's own 2025 paper says the precision of the technology often leads to inaccuracies.

Those inaccuracies "must be verified by pavement engineers."



Thin cracks still score the lowest.

The largest gain came on the thinnest cracks.



One 2025 paper by this group.

The score still aims the money.

The release names three next steps and dates none of them.

The commission meets September 24th in Austin, open to the public. Agendas post eight days ahead and none of the four left this year has one.

TEXAS AI DOCKET